POSITIONING & REPOSITIONING

# 16 Indian Brand Stories Students Can Learn From

*How iconic Indian brands found their place in the customer's mind — and how they changed it*

A Marketing Case-Study Deck

# Two Ideas We Will See Again and Again

## POSITIONING

The distinct, meaningful place a brand occupies in the customer's mind, relative to competitors.

**Example:** Fevicol positioned itself on one word — unbreakable strength — and owned it for decades.

## REPOSITIONING

Deliberately changing that place — usually because the market, customer, or competition has moved.

**Example:** Lifebuoy moved from "cheap carbolic soap" to a global health & hygiene mission.

PART ONE

# Positioning: Owning a Space From Day One

*Brands that picked a clear idea and never let go of it*

POSITIONING CASE 01 / 8

# Fevicol

ADHESIVES



## THE CORE POSITIONING

**"Fevicol ka jod hai, tootega nahi" — the strongest, most unbreakable bond**

### TARGET AUDIENCE

Carpenters, contractors & households

### WHAT MADE IT STICK

Owned ONE word — unbreakable strength — for decades

### DATA POINT

**70%+**

Approx. share long held in India’s branded adhesive market

POSITIONING CASE 02 / 8

# Amul

DAIRY / FMCG



## THE CORE POSITIONING

**"The Taste of India" — a dependable, witty, everyday dairy brand for every home**

### TARGET AUDIENCE

Every Indian household

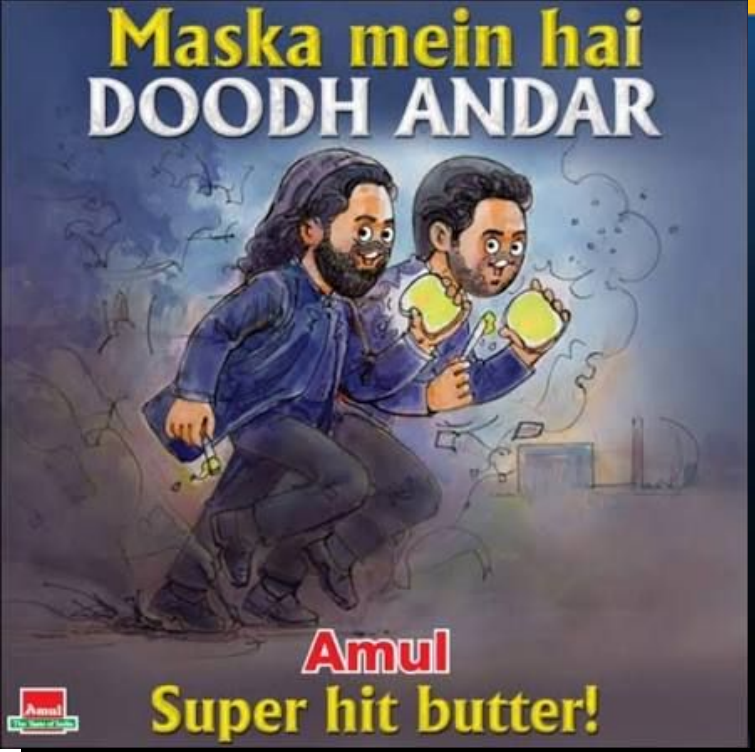
### WHAT MADE IT STICK

Farmer-owned cooperative + topical ads = constant cultural relevance

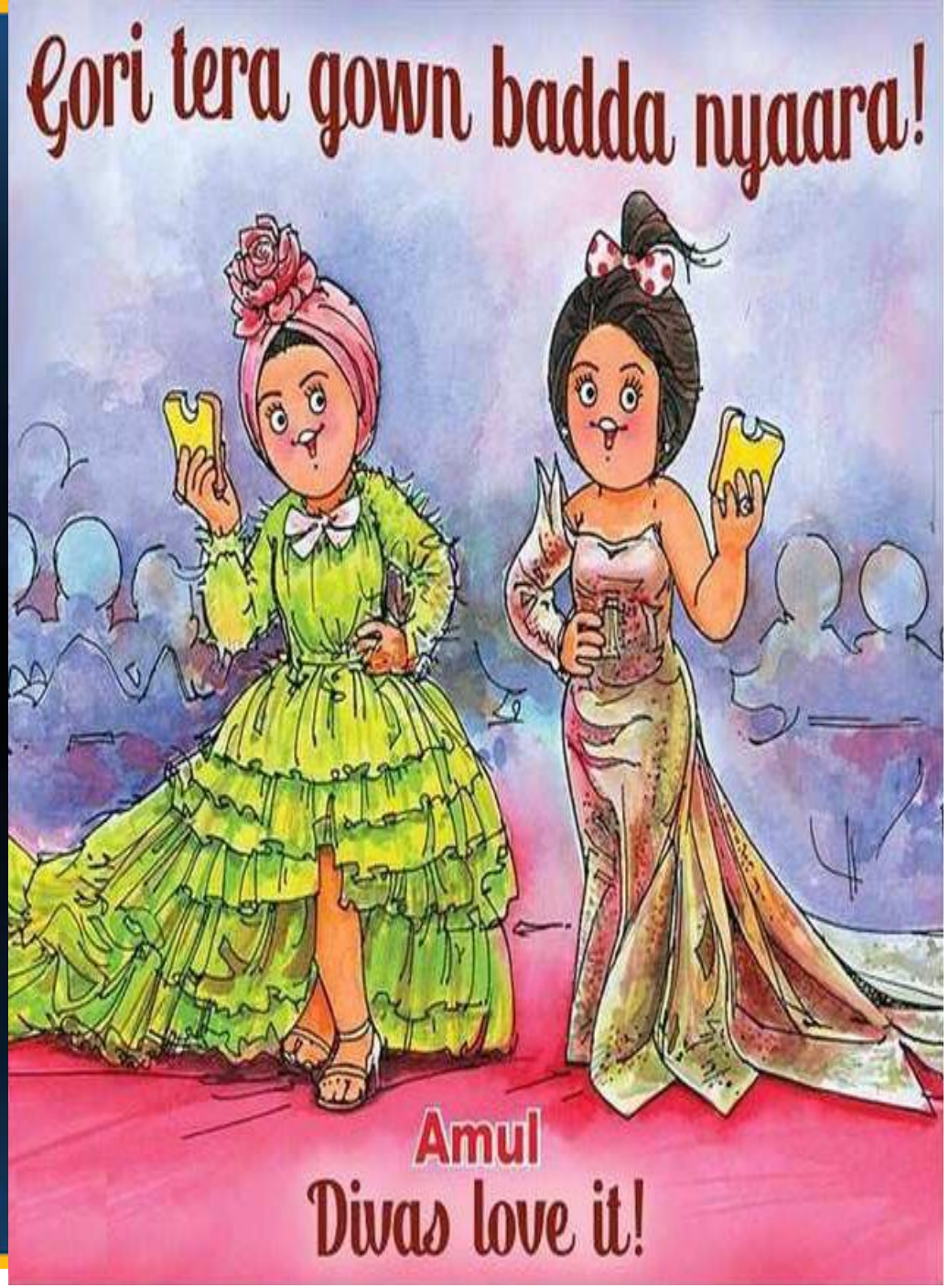
### DATA POINT

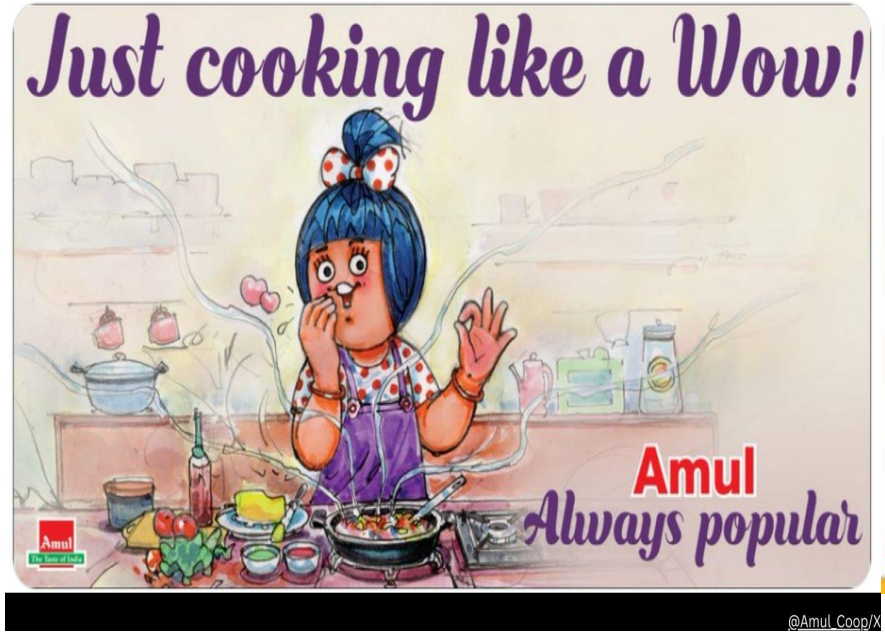
**75+**

Years the iconic Amul Girl topical ads have run


Maska mein hai
DOODH ANDAR
Amul
Super hit butter!


Amul Goes International:
"Amul Doodh Ab Piyega America!
The Taste of India.
Now in USA.
Amul
Milk
afaqs!


Gori tera gown badda nyaara!
Amul
Divas love it!


Just cooking like a Wow!
Amul
Always popular
@Amul_Coop/X

POSITIONING CASE 03 / 8

# Raymond

APPAREL / FABRIC



## THE CORE POSITIONING

**"The Complete Man" — fabric as a symbol of success & masculinity**

### TARGET AUDIENCE

Middle to upper-class Indian men

### WHAT MADE IT STICK

Sold an identity and an aspiration, not just cloth

### DATA POINT

**1990**

Decade "The Complete Man" campaign began

POSITIONING CASE 04 / 8

# Parle-G

BISCUITS / FMCG



THE CORE POSITIONING

**"G for Genius" — affordable nutrition & everyday energy for every Indian**

TARGET AUDIENCE

Mass, price-sensitive households

WHAT MADE IT STICK

Unbeatable price-to-nutrition value, never chased premium

DATA POINT

**#1**

Long claimed as the world’s largest-selling biscuit brand by volume

POSITIONING CASE 05 / 8

# Kingfisher

BEVERAGES / LIFESTYLE



## THE CORE POSITIONING

**"King of Good Times" — a lifestyle badge of youth, fun & celebration**

### TARGET AUDIENCE

Young, urban, socially active audience

### WHAT MADE IT STICK

Positioned a beverage as a lifestyle, not just a drink

### DATA POINT

**1978**

Launch year of the Kingfisher brand

POSITIONING CASE 06 / 8

# Nirma

DETERGENTS



THE CORE POSITIONING

**"Sabki Pasand Nirma" — honest, value-for-money cleaning power**

TARGET AUDIENCE

Price-sensitive middle & lower-income households

WHAT MADE IT STICK

Positioned on price when every rival chased premium

DATA POINT

**1969**

Founding year of Nirma

POSITIONING CASE 07 / 8

# Patanjali

FMCG / AYURVEDA



## THE CORE POSITIONING

**"Swadeshi & natural" — Ayurveda-based products for everyday life**

### TARGET AUDIENCE

Health-conscious,
value-and-nation-minded consumers

### WHAT MADE IT STICK

"Natural + Made in India" as the single core promise

### DATA POINT

**2016**

Peak growth year that rattled FMCG incumbents

POSITIONING CASE 08 / 8

# OYO

HOSPITALITY



## THE CORE POSITIONING

**A trusted, predictable budget stay — anywhere in India**

### TARGET AUDIENCE

Budget & first-time travellers

### WHAT MADE IT STICK

Standardised experience in a category that had none

### DATA POINT

**2013**

Founding year of OYO Rooms

PART TWO

# Repositioning: Changing the Story

*Brands that deliberately moved to a new place in the customer's mind*

REPOSITIONING CASE 01 / 8

# Maruti Suzuki

AUTOMOBILES



POSITIONED AS (BEFORE)

Mass-market "everyman" car brand

REPOSITIONED AS (AFTER)

**"NEXA" premium retail experience for aspirational buyers**

DATA POINT

**2015**

Year NEXA launched to sell premium models like Baleno & Ciaz

REPOSITIONING CASE 02 / 8

# Titan

WATCHES

POSITIONED AS (BEFORE)

Challenger vs. HMT — "just a time-telling device"

REPOSITIONED AS (AFTER)

**A fashion & lifestyle accessory; spun off youth brand Fastrack**

DATA POINT

#1

Became India’s leading watch brand within a decade of launch (1984)

REPOSITIONING CASE 03 / 8

# Cadbury Dairy Milk

CHOCOLATE / FMCG



**POSITIONED AS (BEFORE)**

A treat "only for children"

**REPOSITIONED AS (AFTER)**

**"Kuch Meetha Ho Jaye" — an everyday indulgence for all ages & occasions**

**DATA POINT**

**1994**

Year the iconic "Kuch Meetha Ho Jaye" campaign repositioned the brand

REPOSITIONING CASE 04 / 8

# Lifebuoy

PERSONAL CARE



POSITIONED AS (BEFORE)

Carbolic soap sold on smell & germ-kill for working class

REPOSITIONED AS (AFTER)

**Modern health & hygiene brand — "H for Handwashing" behaviour-change platform**

DATA POINT

**5**

Global "Help a Child Reach 5" campaign tied handwashing to child survival

REPOSITIONING CASE 05 / 8

# Surf Excel

DETERGENTS



POSITIONED AS (BEFORE)

Functional promise — "removes tough stains"

REPOSITIONED AS (AFTER)

**"Daag Achhe Hain" — stains as proof of learning & good childhood values**

DATA POINT

**2010**

Year "Dirt is Good" platform launched, shifting from function to values

REPOSITIONING CASE 06 / 8

# Bajaj Auto

TWO-WHEELERS



POSITIONED AS (BEFORE)

"Hamara Bajaj" — dependable family scooter, nostalgia-led

REPOSITIONED AS (AFTER)

**Pulsar — sporty, performance-led positioning for young riders**

DATA POINT

**2001**

Year Pulsar launched with "Definitely Male", resetting the brand’s energy

# Airtel

TELECOM



POSITIONED AS (BEFORE)

Functional connectivity — network & call quality

REPOSITIONED AS (AFTER)

**"Har Ek Friend Zaroori Hota Hai" — emotional, youth-first storytelling**

DATA POINT

**2010**

Year the "Friendship" campaign moved Airtel from features to feelings

REPOSITIONING CASE 08 / 8

# Tata Tea

BEVERAGES



POSITIONED AS (BEFORE)

Commodity tea sold on taste & aroma

REPOSITIONED AS (AFTER)

**"Jaago Re" — a social-awakening platform on voting & civic issues**

DATA POINT

**2007**

Year "Jaago Re" launched, linking a cup of tea to civic consciousness

# The Big Takeaway

1

## Positioning is a choice.

Fevicol, Amul & Parle-G show that owning ONE clear idea beats trying to be everything.

2

## Repositioning is survival.

Lifebuoy, Surf Excel & Titan changed their story when the market or customer moved on.

3

## Data should follow the brand, not lead it.

Every case here started with a customer insight — then measured what mattered.